



Security Watch

Chrome's Loops And holes

The Problem

Google Chrome, the new born browser hits a roadblock when it tries to handle the Javascripts methods `onbeforeload` and `onunload`.

This bug seems to affect Chrome users running versions 0.2.149.xx on Windows XP-based computers. The bug messes up Chrome when it gets into an infinite loop with the commands `onbeforeload` and `onunload`.

This means trouble makers can implement this code to initiate a loop in a simple page. In the example shown by Aditya K Sood, the following code in a page gets Google Chrome hung up.

```
<body
onbeforeunload="for
( var chrome_t = 0;
chrome_t < 999999;
chrome_t++) {
alert('I think we're
bugging Chrome');
}return false;">
```

Initially, the CPU utilisation shoots up, and slows Chrome to a crawl. Then, Google Chrome refuses to close and has to be forcibly shut using the Windows task manager.

The Solution

Google has apparently acknowledged the problem, and a fix expected anytime soon.

Google has an auto-updater utility that runs alongside Google Chrome that keeps the browser up-to-date. When the fix is available, it will be automatically downloaded and patched. When you read this, try the code, and if it doesn't affect Chrome, you know it's been patched.

from Google, it originated from the iPhone. Jonathan Zdziarski, an independent iPhone developer recently came across a secret line of code in the iPhone Operating system containing a URL. Days later, this spread all across the tech arena, and soon questions were left for Steve Jobs to answer.

Jobs eventually accepted the presence of a kill switch in iPhone's operating system meant to kill third-party applications that run on an iPhone to avoid malware and other harmful applications from running on the iPhone. Jobs insisted it was precautionary rather than a function.

With the launch of the G1 from Google, things have moved far off with the detection of a kill switch in it as well. With companies deciding for the end consumer what application should be run, there is concern over end-user privacy. Although, both Google and Apple would release statements claiming that the privacy of the end-user is duly respected, the very fact that they know what application you run on their products is discomfoting.



This is similar to Windows sending error codes to Microsoft's servers without asking for your permission.

ENOUGH ALREADY!

More Yahoo!, Google And Microsoft Chatter

The Yahoo!-Microsoft imbroglio seems to have gone through an extended gestation period. It's high time we heard of



Jerry Yang,
Yahoo! Co Founder

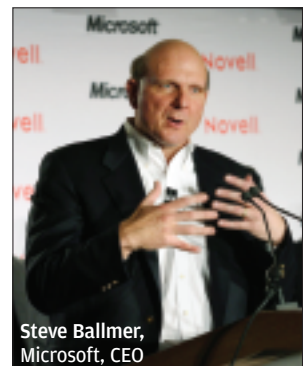
the birth of a new entity. All the expectations are justified, at least with all the attention the whole affair has been receiving, and the limbo it has been over the past nine odd months!

It all started close to a year ago with Microsoft pitching in to buy-out Yahoo!. Steve Ballmer and Jerry Wang were in the news. At times the stock price was the debate, while in the recent past, Google entered the limelight. There were talks of Google entering a deal with Yahoo! to offset Microsoft from gaining hold of the online marketing business.

However, as per recent reports, Google and Yahoo! have decided to put the online advertising deal on hold. This was announced

by both, Yahoo! and Google in a recent statement, after deciding to wait for responses from the Department of Justice. Microsoft was quick to take advantage of the situation and go ahead and announce that the online deal with Yahoo! is still sensible, despite what happened and that it may still be possible.

Ballmer also said that the two companies are not currently negotiating, ever since talks fell apart in July. In May, Yahoo! had rejected a \$33-per share offer that amounted to \$47.5 billion, with a reason



Steve Ballmer,
Microsoft, CEO

that the company was worth much more than said figure. However, this was the case before Wall Street crashed and burned, as a result of the global financial crunch.

However, in the current scenario, the impact on Yahoo! share prices is being closely studied by Microsoft. Ballmer has already hinted that they expect to see opportunities to have a partnership later. The impact of failed talks has been graver on Yahoo! than it has been on Microsoft. Share prices have fallen to a five-and-half-year low of \$11.37. Perhaps that \$33 per share offer wasn't so bad, was it Jerry? As for the rest of the world, we've just had enough. Will someone please buy someone else and end all this speculation?